

Partnership Proposal: GGP x Take-Two Interactive

Renewing and Expanding Our Partnership · 12 Months · July 2026 to July 2027

Prepared by Gay Gaming Professionals · Draft 6 · June 3, 2026

Cover

To: Alan Lewis, VP Corporate Communications & Public Affairs, Take-Two Interactive (cc as appropriate: Chanel Ward, Molly Sewalk, Ethan Friedman / 2K leadership; Isabella Begazo, T2 NY) **From:** Gordon Bellamy, CEO, Gay Gaming Professionals **Subject:** Renewing what we built, three options for July 2026 to July 2027 with the Directory as the new anchor **Read-ahead for:** the next standing **EXCELLENCE** cadence meeting

Why now

Twenty years of GGP. **Six years of partnership with Take-Two, every year since 2019, the most consistent corporate partnership in our history.** The CYSTEM Mentorship Program you and I formalized in 2023 is still placing students into careers, including the **first GGP Scholar Alum named to Forbes 30 Under 30 (September 2025).** The annual **2K Studio Tour at GDC** has become tradition. You personally participated again at GDC 2026, and your presence at the **GGP Scholars Breakfast** that Christopher Kim coordinated last year was felt across the whole cohort. The "EXCELLENCE" cadence keeps working.

This year, our shared work has a new structural moment. The **US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline Directory** is ready. A board-ready map of the field, from elementary through graduate, with AI readiness as a first-class category, with **"where dollars go furthest"** tags on every entry. It is the artifact your board has been

waiting for: navigable, donor-facing, student-facing, and built to be quarterly-refreshed at **gaygamingpros.org/directory**. **Take-Two as the named launch partner of the Directory makes it the structural anchor of the games-education field.** That is bigger than any single year of programming. It positions Take-Two as anchoring the next generation of games-education infrastructure for everyone, not just the cohort we directly serve.

Now the talent pipeline also needs us at our best. The students we are mentoring this year are graduating into the hardest entry-level market in two decades. **AI readiness** has become the new threshold question for talent attraction in the games industry. Take-Two's own April 2026 recalibration of its AI strategy is a public signal of where the puck is going. And our shared work, supporting *all students pursuing careers in games, including those from underestimated communities*, has never been more relevant to Take-Two's culture and to the next generation.

This document proposes **three options** for renewing our partnership for the **next 12 months (July 2026 to July 2027)**. All three slot inside an existing partnership budget structure. All three are framed as continuations of work we already do well together, **with the Directory as the new spine. None require approvals beyond the corporate communications and partnerships function.**

Three options at a glance

Option	Investment	Best for
Option A · Directory Launch	\$40,000	Anchor the Directory as a public good, named launch partner
Option B · Directory + Pipeline + AI 🌟	\$100,000	The best year of the partnership, on the existing relationship footing
Option C · Multi-Year Flagship	\$250,000 over 24 months	Two-year flagship with co-branded Directory and full pipeline support

We are presenting all three because the choice belongs at Take-Two. **Our recommendation is Option B.** It anchors the Directory as a public-good launch, continues every program we already run together, and adds the AI readiness layer 2026

calls for. **At \$100K, Option B is the best year in the partnership's history in dollar terms, while remaining inside the budget envelope you already operate in.**

Option A · Directory Launch · \$40,000

\$40,000 · 12-month engagement · Pride 2026 launch

The Directory exists in draft. Option A funds its public launch as a Take-Two-anchored resource.

What it delivers: - Public web launch of the US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline at **gaygamingpros.org/directory** - Filterable + searchable interface (by age, region, cost, audience served, AI-readiness) - **"Powered by Take-Two Interactive, launch partner"** attribution prominently displayed - **200+ programs** in the launch directory with verified scope data - Quarterly refresh cycle for 12 months - Annual report on directory usage with downloadable cuts for funders and educators

Where it shows up: - gaygamingpros.org/directory (primary) - Cross-posted to GGP YouTube channel for launch announcement - Press cycle at Pride 2026 launch: GamesBeat, PocketGamer.biz, Polygon, EdSurge - Annual report at end-of-year showing reach and engagement

What we own: directory build, hosting, editorial standards, quarterly refresh, press **What Take-Two owns:** launch-partner brand approvals, launch comms participation

Honest assessment: Option A is the structural-anchor play. It positions Take-Two as the partner who made navigation of the games-education field possible. It does *not* extend the **CYSTEM Mentorship**, the **2K Studio Tour**, the **Scholars Breakfast**, or fund the **AI readiness** module. Several pieces of our existing partnership are left on the table.

Option B · Directory + Pipeline + AI ★

Our recommended choice

\$100,000 · 12-month engagement · spans Pride 2026 to GDC 2027 to Pride 2027

Option B leads with the Directory as the public good, continues every structural piece of our existing partnership, and adds the AI readiness layer.

What it delivers:

B.1 · Directory Launch + Year-1 Maintenance (\$50,000)

Everything in Option A, plus: - **Donor-facing dashboard:** gap maps, cost-per-outcome, "where dollars go furthest" surfaced as a funder lens - **Verified outcomes data** for the top 50 programs (research procurement is the work this funds) - **AI-readiness overlay** tagging every entry: which programs already include AI-tool fluency, which would benefit from an AI module overlay - **Expanded launch scope** to ~250 programs with deeper data

B.2 · Named Take-Two CYSTEM Cohort (\$30,000)

A 12-month cohort of **10 scholars** from across the country, supporting all students pursuing careers in games, including those from underestimated communities. **CYSTEM Year 4** under Alex Rogers's continued leadership. Take-Two named on the cohort; scholarship dollars stacked from existing GGP CYSTEM funder mix to reach full per-scholar amounts.

- \$2,000 Take-Two anchor portion per scholar × 10 = \$20,000 (stacked with CYSTEM co-funders to full scholarship amount)
- \$1,000 GDC 2027 travel stipend × 10 = \$10,000
- 1-on-1 ERG mentor pairings (each scholar matched with a Take-Two ERG member)
- 6 mentor sessions over the year, GGP-curated

B.3 · Annual 2K Studio Tour + Scholars Breakfast, Take-Two as named industry sponsor of GDC 2027 (\$15,000)

- Underwrites the **2K Studio Tour** for the cohort and the **GGP Scholars Breakfast** at GDC 2027 in San Francisco
- Both are existing traditions Alan personally values and participates in
- Take-Two named as the industry sponsor, visible at the event, in press, and in our annual report

B.4 · AI Readiness Track for the Rising Generation (\$5,000)

Brand-new addition. Embedded in CYSTEM and the Directory.

- "AI in the Studio" curriculum module added to CYSTEM Mentorship
- 1 to 2 AI fluency office hours led by Take-Two engineers
- "AI in the Studio" segment within the 2K Studio Tour at GDC 2027
- The Directory's AI-readiness overlay feeds back into this work

Outcomes (12-month metrics): - Directory: live at gaygamingpros.org/directory by Pride 2026; **5,000+ unique users in year 1**; 250+ programs at launch; quarterly refresh hit on schedule - Press: 1,500+ press impressions across the Pride 2026 launch cycle - Cohort: 10 scholars deployed, 80% mentor-pairing completion, at least 2 cohort members hired into industry roles by July 2027 - 2K Tour + Breakfast: 45+ scholars in attendance at GDC 2027 (matches 2026 baseline) - AI track: 100% of cohort completes the module; at least 3 case-study reflections published - Relationship: renewable into Option C for 2027 to 2028 if all four land

What we own: directory build + maintenance, scholarship deployment, mentor curation, AI curriculum, GDC programming, public storytelling **What Take-Two owns:** launch-partner brand presence, ERG access for mentor pool, AI engineer access (1 to 2 sessions), brand approvals, breakfast presence

Option C · Multi-Year Flagship

\$250,000 over 24 months (July 2026 to July 2028) · \$125,000 per year average

Option C is presented if Take-Two wants to make GGP x Take-Two a named multi-year flagship anchored on the Directory.

What it would add on top of Option B: - **Year 2 mirroring** of the cohort + Studio Tour + Breakfast - **Directory expanded to 400+ programs** with full verified outcomes data, hosted under prominent co-branding: **"Powered by Take-Two Interactive"** anchor positioning - **A New York-based mirror of the GGP x G4C charity poker tournament** (the inaugural one, hosted by Mike + Amy Morhaime, just funded two GGP/G4C Scholars for 2026 to 2027; appetite to mirror) - *Optional add-on:* a second "Belonging Round 3" video series in 2027 if Take-Two wants the dual-asset package (~\$30K incremental, not included in Option C base)

Honest assessment: Option C is a real commitment, \$125,000 per year for two years. It would make GGP x Take-Two the most visible games-education infrastructure partnership in the industry at this scale tier. We are presenting it because some of our peer organizations have suggested Take-Two might want this scale of visibility around major 2027 launches. We respect Take-Two's discipline on commitments and are not pushing Option C unless the bandwidth is there.

What changes vs. our existing partnership

Across all three options, **nothing about how we already work together changes**. The 2K Studio Tour stays. The mentorship structure stays. Our annual cadence with Alan stays. The Scholars Breakfast at GDC stays. **What is new is the Directory becoming the structural anchor of the partnership** · a public good that lives beyond any single year of programming.

Why Option B is right for July 2026 to July 2027

- **At \$100,000, it is the best year of the partnership in dollar terms while still inside Alan's existing partnership budget envelope**, no escalation required
- **The Directory makes Take-Two's name structural in the field**, not just a single-year asset
- **It renews three traditions Take-Two already participates in** (CYSTEM mentorship, 2K Studio Tour, Scholars Breakfast)
- **It adds AI readiness**, the talent-pipeline question every games company is currently navigating, including Take-Two
- **It costs less than a single tier-2 GDC sponsorship line item** but produces compounding pipeline value across 12 months
- **At \$10,000 per direct beneficiary** (10 scholars), it is well below industry benchmarks for entry-level pipeline ROI
- **It positions Take-Two as the industry's most consistent partner** in supporting the rising generation, exactly when consistency is rare

- **The Sinjin / Bigglesworth Family Foundation parallel partnership** (the *T2 2025 Support* thread you and Sinjin opened, plus the Bigglesworth-sponsored IGNITE Impact Challenge in cycle now) means GGP is already sitting at the connective tissue between two of Take-Two's natural funder peers, a structural advantage for any multi-year flagship

Risk + mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Take-Two budget constraint in 2026	Option A is the fallback; Option B is structured so each component can be modular if needed
Directory launch delays	Pride 2026 launch decoupled from GDC 2027 deliverables; phased release acceptable (beta → public)
Mentor matching at scale	GGP pre-recruits 15+ Take-Two ERG members for the pool; mentor handbook + monthly office hours
AI track scope creep	Curriculum is delivered by GGP partners; Take-Two provides 1 to 2 engineer office hours, not full curriculum ownership
Directory outcomes data not available for all programs	Top 50 verified at launch; longer-tail entries flagged as "scope only"; outcomes filled in across the year
Conflicts with Take-Two's existing ERG load	All asks scoped to 6 hours or less per ERG member per year

What we need from Take-Two

1. **A point person**, Alan, ideally, with a 2K and Zynga ERG liaison
2. **Launch-partner brand approval** for the Directory, with co-branding rights under staged review

3. **ERG access**, 15+ in the mentor pool (Option B piece); 6 to 10 ERG members for optional Directory-launch content
 4. **AI engineer access**, 1 to 2 Take-Two engineers for office hours and the GDC 2027 segment
 5. **Communications coordination**, a joint Pride 2026 Directory-launch press cycle and joint GDC 2027 moment
 6. **An MOU and a contract**. Option B paid in three tranches: 50% at kickoff (July 2026), 25% at Directory public launch (Pride 2026), 25% at GDC 2027
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Why GGP, and why now

- **Track record:** 20 years of cultivating top performers in the games industry. First GGP Scholar Alum on Forbes 30 Under 30 (Sept 2025). Audrey Webb at Roblox. Ami Cai at NYS Empire State Development. Christopher Kim at USC Marshall.
- **Organizational stability: Eric Francksen formally takes the title Executive Producer, GGP, in 2026.** He has been the operational backbone for six years. Take-Two's GGP work runs through him in practice: the 2K Studio Tour, the Scholars Breakfast coordination, the CYSTEM year-over-year cadence.
- **Ecosystem position:** GDC 2026 partnership with Informa. **IGNITE Impact Challenge** with Eric Francksen, Bec Godsey, and Games for Change, sponsored by **Bigglesworth Family Foundation** (Sinjin Bain), in cycle now with submissions closing May 29. GGP is a *budgeted participant* in the IIC partnership, not a pass-through sponsor; the partner-tier seat is structured at the Bigglesworth + G4C level. Global Game Jam host (third year). Co-funded scholars with Games for Change via the Mike + Amy Morhaime charity poker tournament. We sit at the connective tissue.
- **Collegiate Games Challenge, inaugural year wrapped cleanly in August 2025:** \$90,000 awarded across 21 invited universities, three categories (Interactive, Business, Cinematic), with Raw Thrills (Eugene Jarvis) as the inaugural underwriting partner. USC, Michigan State, SCAD, and Indiana University were all in the recognized cohort. The 2026 cycle is in development; partner-of-record not yet announced.
- **Directory infrastructure ready:** Draft 3 is in hand. Editorial standards defined. Hosting plan in place. The web build, donor-facing dashboard, and AI-readiness overlay are the funded scope of work this proposal anchors.

- **Faculty presence:** USC Games faculty (Gordon), with **USC Games' Tracy Fullerton on the Games for Change board** and Tencent's Ben Golant also on G4C. The board overlap is real.
 - **Talent pipeline depth:** GGP Scholars + CYSTEM + Collegiate Games Challenge + Global Game Jam + GGP x G4C funded scholars = **five programs each touching different points of the pipeline.**
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Companion documents (delivered alongside this proposal)

- **US Video Game Education & Scholars Pipeline, Starter Directory, Draft 3**
(attached; the artifact this proposal launches)
 - **Pipeline One-Sheet, Where GGP sits in the games-education ecosystem** *(available on request)*
 - **Relationship Research Brief, Draft 2** *(internal; available on request)*
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Next step

A 30-minute call with Alan, and whoever from 2K he wants on the line, at the next standing **EXCELLENCE** cadence to:

1. Confirm Option B (or remix)
2. Co-develop the Directory launch comms and Pride 2026 cycle
3. Lock the budget tranche structure
4. Commit to a Directory launch window
5. Calendar the GDC 2027 moment

Gordon is ready when Take-Two is.

*Built to be shared with the Take-Two Foundation board. Easy to read, easy to forward, easy to say yes to. The Directory is the asset this proposal puts in your board's hands.***